

Friday, 4 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 21° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Rain 19° 15°	MANCHESTER Rain 18° 15°	GLASGOW Light rain 16° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Donald Trump has hinted the US might not back the UK over the Falkland Islands, due to a perceived lack of support in his ongoing war with Iran.

The US President made the comments during a press conference, suggesting the UK "was not there to help me" in his conflict. It raises questions about the long-standing alliance between the two nations and future diplomatic relations.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

The Green Party leader, Zack Polanski, has announced he will run for Sir Keir Starmer's former parliamentary seat in the upcoming by-election.

Sir Keir recently resigned as an MP, triggering a by-election in Holborn and St Pancras. Polanski's decision sets the stage for a potentially closely watched political contest.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

The Home Office is attempting to withhold MI5 information from inquests into a synagogue attack, which are due to take place next year.

The move raises concerns about transparency and the public's right to know in cases involving national security. The inquests are expected to examine the circumstances surrounding the attack in detail.

CRIME · UK
- 4

A college lecturer has admitted causing the deaths of a husband and wife in a drink-drive crash last December.

Sophie Hynd pleaded guilty to causing the deaths of Jatinder Kaur, 48, and Satwant Singh, 64, in Fife. The tragic incident occurred during the festive period.

CRIME · UK
- 5

A man has admitted killing a 12-year-old schoolboy in a hit-and-run crash in Coventry.

Dolars Aleksanders' car struck Keaton Slater as the boy was making his way home from school. The tragic incident shocked the local community.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1

After more than a decade, Amelia Dimoldenberg has announced she's closing the doors on her hugely popular YouTube series, Chicken Shop Date.

The show, known for its awkward and hilarious interviews with celebrities in chicken shops, has been a massive hit. Amelia shared the news, thanking fans for their support over the years.

ON AIR – Are you sad to see Chicken Shop Date go? Who was your favourite guest?

TV & FILM · COMING UP

2

George Michael's iconic 'Faith' guitar is set to go up for auction, offering fans a chance to own a piece of music history.

The guitar, famously played by Michael in the music video for his hit song 'Faith', is part of a collection belonging to his former personal assistant. It's expected to attract significant interest from collectors.

ON AIR – If you could own one piece of music memorabilia, what would it be?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3

Star Wars creator George Lucas and his wife have opened a new museum, featuring over 1,200 works of art, from Star Wars to Banksy.

The Lucas Museum of Narrative Art promises to be a visual feast, showcasing a diverse collection that spans various artistic styles and periods. It's a must-visit for art and film enthusiasts alike.

ON AIR – What's your favourite piece of movie memorabilia or art?

ARTS & CULTURE · COMING UP

4

Fans are praising Catherine Zeta-Jones for embracing her natural Welsh accent in her new thriller series.

The Hollywood star, originally from Swansea, is using her authentic voice in the new show, much to the delight of viewers. It's a refreshing change for many who are used to hearing her with an American accent.

ON AIR – Do you prefer to hear actors use their natural accent, or do you like them to transform for a role?

TV & FILM · COMING UP

5

A new wave of queens, raised on Drag Race UK, are among the 12 contestants set to compete for the series eight crown.

The hit reality show is back, and this season promises a fresh set of talent ready to battle it out for the coveted title. Expect fierce competition and fabulous looks!

ON AIR – Who are you rooting for in the new series of Drag Race UK?

TV & FILM · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Richarlison has been omitted from Tottenham's Premier League squad, as he doesn't feature in the club's plans for the season.**

This is big news for Spurs fans, with the Brazilian forward seemingly out of favour. It raises questions about his future at the club and potential transfer moves.

ON AIR – Do you think Richarlison will find a new club before the transfer window closes?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Issy Wong's first international five-wicket haul led England to a dominant six-wicket win over Ireland, sealing the series with a game to spare.**

Wong was in sensational form, tearing through the Irish batting line-up. England's victory means they've wrapped up the three-match series convincingly.

ON AIR – What an incredible performance from Issy Wong! Who do you think is the most exciting young talent in English cricket right now?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Sussex paceman Henry Crocombe has taken a second hat-trick in consecutive games, as Essex lost their last seven wickets for just six runs.**

Crocombe is in incredible form, ripping through opposition batting orders. His double hat-trick feat is a rare and remarkable achievement in cricket.

ON AIR – Two hat-tricks in eight days! Is Henry Crocombe the most in-form bowler in county cricket right now?

CRICKET · UK

4 **Spain's Enric Mas has extended his overall lead in the Vuelta a Espana with a late attack, as Slovenia's Jakob Odrizolek won stage 12.**

Mas put in a strong performance to gain time on his rivals, solidifying his position at the top of the general classification. The race continues to be a thrilling spectacle.

ON AIR – The Vuelta a Espana is really heating up! Who do you think will ultimately take the red jersey?

CYCLING · EUROPE

5 **Lewis Hamilton says an upgraded Ferrari engine for this weekend's Italian Grand Prix is a "step forward but not the whole amount we need."**

Hamilton's comments suggest that while there's progress, Ferrari still has work to do to catch up with their rivals. All eyes will be on Monza to see if the upgrades make a significant difference.

ON AIR – Do you think Ferrari's upgrades will be enough to challenge for victory at Monza, or is Red Bull still too dominant?

FORMULA 1 · EUROPE

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that the simple act of 'doodling during meetings' could actually boost memory and concentration.**

Far from being a sign of distraction, researchers found that people who doodled whilst listening to information remembered more key details. Perhaps it's time to stock up on the colourful pens for your next work catch-up!

- 2 The enduring appeal of 'traditional British seaside holidays' is seeing a charming resurgence, with bookings up for coastal towns.**

Families are rediscovering the joy of classic arcades, sandy beaches, and fish and chips by the sea, opting for nostalgic getaways over international travel.

- 3 The trend for 'upcycling old furniture' is booming, as more people get creative with heirlooms and charity shop finds.**

Instead of buying new, many are transforming old dressers, tables, and chairs with a lick of paint or new upholstery, giving them a fresh lease of life and a unique touch.

- 4 Gardening enthusiasts are increasingly embracing 'companion planting' to create thriving, natural ecosystems in their backyards.**

This technique involves planting certain species together that benefit each other, like marigolds to deter pests, reducing the need for artificial interventions.

- 5 A delightful new movement encourages 'leaving uplifting notes in public places' to spread small moments of joy.**

These handwritten messages, often found tucked into library books or on park benches, offer positive affirmations or kind words for strangers to discover.

- 6 Interest in 'foraging for wild edibles' is growing across the UK, with guided walks becoming ever more popular.**

People are learning to identify and safely harvest wild herbs, berries, and mushrooms, connecting with nature and discovering new culinary flavours.

- 7 More people are finding 'solace in stargazing', with dark sky discovery sites reporting increased visitor numbers.**

Escaping city lights to gaze at the night sky offers a calming escape and a chance to marvel at the vastness of the universe.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING THE BAG A LITTLE SHAKE OR A SQUEEZE TO 'FEEL' THE TEXTURE OR 'HEAR' THE RUSTLE OF THE CRISPS INSIDE.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm bath, especially if it's a new scent of bath oil. What is it?

ANSWER: CAREFULLY ARRANGING ALL THE BATH PRODUCTS AND A TOWEL 'JUST SO' ON THE SIDE, ALMOST LIKE PREPARING A LITTLE DISPLAY.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular place or landmark' in your local area just holds so many memories or has a really unique story attached to it?

What's that special place for you, and what makes it so memorable or intriguing?

- We all have those 'little everyday sounds' that just make us feel instantly happy or bring a smile to our face, don't we?

What's that everyday sound for you that just sparks joy, and why do you love it so much?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is actually called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that male seahorses are the ones who give birth to their young, carrying them in a special pouch?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible from outer space.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar.
- The Eiffel Tower can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to the thermal expansion of the iron.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The only letter that doesn't appear in the name of any U.S. state is the letter 'Q'.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as wallpaper.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.

On this day

Day 247 of the year, 118 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Candida the Elder; Christian feast day: Blessed Catherine of Racconigi; Christian feast day: Blessed Dina Bélanger; Christian feast day: Hermione of Ephesus. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1993 — Emma Brownlie, Scottish footballer
- 1978 — Wes Bentley, American actor and producer
- 1961 — Nick Binko, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1994 — Thomas Minns, English rugby player
- 1968 — John DiMaggio, American voice actor
- 1945 — Danny Gatton, American guitarist (died 1994)
- 1946 — Gary Duncan, American guitarist (died 2019)
- 1996 — Jordan Lilley, English rugby league player

THE DAY TODAY

- 1964 — Scotland's Forth Road Bridge near Edinburgh officially opens.
- 2020 — Pope Benedict XVI becomes the longest-lived pope, 93 years, four months, 16 days, surpassing Pope Leo XIII, who died in 1903.
- 1950 — Darlington Raceway is the site of the inaugural Southern 500, the first 500-mile NASCAR race.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2002 — The Oakland Athletics win their 20th consecutive game, an American League record, until the Cleveland Indians surpassed it in 2017.
- 1970 — Salvador Allende is elected President of Chile.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1941 — World War II: A German submarine makes the first attack of the war against a United States warship, the USS Greer.
- 1971 — Alaska Airlines Flight 1866 crashes near Juneau, Alaska, killing all 111 people on board.

- 1950 — Darlington Raceway is the site of the inaugural Southern 500, the first 500-mile NASCAR race.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 248 of the year, 117 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Bertin; Christian feast day: Charbel (martyr); Christian feast day: Genebald; Christian feast day: Gregorio Aglipay (Episcopal Church). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1974 — Lauren Jeska, British fell runner convicted of the attempted murder of Ralph Knibbs
- 1970 — Johnny Vegas, English actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1946 — Freddie Mercury, British singer and songwriter (died 1991)
- 1946 — Dean Ford, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2018)
- 1947 — Buddy Miles, American singer-songwriter and drummer (died 2008)
- 1945 — Al Stewart, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1984 — Annabelle Wallis, English actress
- 1969 — Dweezil Zappa, American actor and musician

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1986 — Pan Am Flight 73 from Mumbai, India with 358 people on board is hijacked at Karachi International Airport.
- 2012 — An accidental explosion at a Turkish Army ammunition store in Afyon, western Turkey kills 25 soldiers and wounds four others.
- 1990 — Sri Lankan Civil War: Sri Lankan Army soldiers slaughter 158 civilians.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1986 — Pan Am Flight 73 from Mumbai, India with 358 people on board is hijacked at Karachi International Airport.
- 1977 — Voyager Program: NASA launches the Voyager 1 spacecraft.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
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FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
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FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
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FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
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FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar